CONNECTED INTELLIGENCE

YOUR AI TOOL STACK

The right tool for the right task.

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Module 5 — Part A
Exercise

The 6-Question Decision Framework

Most people pick an AI tool by habit, not strategy. These 6 questions give you a repeatable process — so you reach for the right tool automatically, not randomly.

1. **What type of task is this?**
   Writing/drafting, research, analysis, code, creative, or conversation? Different models have different strengths by task type. Start with the task, not the tool.

2. **How much context does it need?**
   Does this task require long documents, full org history, or your Master Prompt plus a 30-page report? Context window capacity varies significantly across platforms.

3. **Does it need real-time web access?**
   Research tasks, current events, live pricing, competitor updates — these need a model with live browsing. Offline models will hallucinate recent information. Know which tools have it before you start.

4. **Is this multimodal?**
   Does the task involve images, PDFs, voice, video, or data files? Multimodal support varies widely. Pasting a screenshot for analysis requires a different tool than pasting text.

5. **What ecosystem are you already in?**
   Google Workspace users get compounding value from Gemini. Microsoft 365 users from Copilot. Deep ecosystem integration reduces friction — don't ignore it. Switching costs are real.

6. **What's the data sensitivity?**
   Is this information you'd put in a public document, an internal system, or nowhere outside the org? Consumer AI tools have different data policies than enterprise deployments. Know where sensitive data can and can't go before you paste it.

> **Decision shortcut:** If you can't answer questions 5 or 6 for your current default tool, stop and find out before your next session. Data sensitivity and ecosystem fit are non-negotiable.

Platform Tendencies + Model Tier Guide

Platform Tendencies

Each major platform has a lane it performs best in. Know the lanes before you assign tasks.

Platform	Best For	Relative Strength	Watch Out For
Claude	Long-form writing, deep analysis, complex reasoning, large documents	Nuance, instruction-following, long context	Limited built-in web access on base plan
ChatGPT	Versatile general use, code, browsing, image generation, plugins	Breadth, ecosystem, tool integrations	Can over-generate; needs tighter constraints
Gemini	Google Workspace integration, multimodal, real-time search	Live data, Google Drive/Docs native	Reasoning depth vs. Claude on complex tasks
Perplexity	Research with live citations, factual lookups, current events	Source transparency, real-time accuracy	Not a writing tool — output needs editing

Model Tier Guide

Your G/Y/R zone from Module 2 suggests which model tier to reach for. Higher tier means more reasoning power — use it when the stakes justify it.

Tier (Examples)	Speed / Cost	Best For	Zone Match
Flagship — Opus, GPT-4o, Gemini Ultra	Slower / Higher	Complex reasoning, high-stakes output, nuanced tasks, long documents	**Yellow** primary
Standard — Sonnet, GPT-4o mini	Balanced	Most everyday work — good quality at reasonable speed	**Green** / **Yellow**
Light — Haiku, Flash, GPT-3.5	Fast / Low	Simple drafts, reformatting, quick lookups, high-volume grunt work	**Green** primary

> **Rule of thumb:** Green tasks rarely need Flagship. Yellow tasks often do. Red tasks — if AI is involved at all on the edges — always use Flagship. Match the tier to the stakes, not to familiarity.

Tool Stack — Example

One default tool handles 70–80% of all tasks. Specialists handle the rest — only where the default genuinely underperforms. Fewer tools used well beat many tools used randomly.

Default Tool: ChatGPT (GPT-4o Standard)

Why: Most versatile for daily use. Handles writing, analysis, brainstorming, and light research in one interface. Plugin ecosystem covers gaps.

Best for: LinkedIn posts, internal emails, meeting summaries, brainstorming, quick lookups, reformatting documents.

Decision rule: Start here unless you already know you need a specialist.

Specialist #1: Claude (Sonnet) — Long-Form & Analysis

Why: Significantly better at long-form reasoning, nuanced instruction-following, and holding complex context across multi-step tasks.

Best for: Client proposals (4–8 pages), strategy documents, analyzing long reports, anything requiring careful tone calibration.

Switch when: Task is 1,000+ words output, stakes are high, or the default returned shallow output twice with different prompts.

Specialist #2: Perplexity — Research with Citations

Why: Live search with visible source citations. When accuracy of current facts matters and hallucination risk can't be accepted.

Best for: Competitor research, market sizing, industry trends, anything requiring verifiable current data.

Switch when: The task involves facts that could have changed in the last 6 months.

Decision Tree (Example)

Condition	Route To
Standard writing, analysis, or brainstorming	**ChatGPT (Default)**
Long-form, high-stakes, or requires deep reasoning	**Claude (Specialist #1)**
Current facts, live data, or citations required	**Perplexity (Specialist #2)**
Images, PDFs, voice, or Google Drive files	**Gemini (Ecosystem play)**
Confidential or sensitive information	**Enterprise deployment only**

Your Tool Stack

Build your own stack below. Start with the default — the one tool you'd use if you could only use one. Add specialists only where you've actually experienced the default falling short.

Default Tool

Tool name & model tier:

Why this is your default:

Best for these task types:

Specialist #1

Tool name & model tier:

Why specialist (not default)?

Use when:

Specialist #2 *(optional)*

Tool name & model tier:

Best for / use when:

Decision Tree + Quick Reference + Reflection

Your Decision Tree

Condition	Route To

MY AI TOOL STACK — Quick Reference

DEFAULT:

RESEARCH:

ANALYSIS / LONG-FORM:

MULTIMODAL:

Sensitive data rule: _____

Decision rule: When in doubt, use my default. Switch only when the task requires it.

Reflection

Tool I'll try that I haven't used much:

When I'll revisit this stack:

- ☐ In 3 months
- ☐ When a major new tool launches
- ☐ When my work significantly changes

What task am I using the wrong tool for right now?

What would change about my workflow if I matched model tier to task zone consistently?